while he was in jail. A famous Sikh religious scholar and revolutionary, Bhai Sahib Bhai Randhir Singh, was imprisoned in Lahore Central Jail from 1930 to 1931 for his activities on behalf of the Ghadar Party. In jail he encountered Bhagat Singh in the condemned cell. Bhagat Singh was an avowed atheist. Despite being condemned to death, he still refused to believe in the existence of God. Bhai Sahib Bhai Randhir Singh attempted to convince him otherwise, whereupon Bhagat Singh wrote the article titled 'Why I Am an Atheist', which was a tract released by Bhagat Singh's family several months after he had been hanged, towards the end of 1931. Adherents of Bhai Sahib Bhai Randhir strenuously insist that the great sage managed to convince Bhagat Singh to return into the fold of Sikhism as he faced the hour of his death in jail. Others think this cannot possibly have been the case. The truth is that this claim is only based on Bhai Randhir Singh's own memoirs.[5] In an attempt to reconstruct his hagiography, it is arguable that he and his supporters would have had every reason to make such a claim. In so doing, one often sees a photograph of Bhagat Singh (which is the only one of him when he was not a child), sitting manacled on a charpoy with hair unshorn in earnest discussion with an elderly man alleged to be Bhai Sahib Bhai Randhir Singh. This, however, is a 1927 photo, when Bhagat Singh was 20 years old. It is during his first arrest following the Dussehra bomb blast, when he is seen sitting with DSP Gopal Singh Pannu. It is not with Bhai Sahib Bhai Randhir Singh at all. Most important, however, is the fact that Bhagat Singh wrote 'Why I Am an Atheist' in prison. This tract was first published in September 1931. That was just six months after Bhagat Singh was executed in March. The fact that it was published with the permission of his family, and in circumstances where not a single one of his comrades in prison had suggested that during his final days he had returned to the fold of Sikhism, suggests that he did not do so and remained an atheist to the end. If his family wished to honour his memory so soon after his execution, they would not have done so by being oblivious to his moral and ethical stance which this essay so powerfully depicts.